

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

UTILI0.09

CONS.0.69

ENERG1.26

INDUS1.40

REAL1.76

CONS.2.02

HEALT2.17

COMM.2.93

TECHN2.94

MATER3.36

FINAN6.16

1

AMZN

BUY

\$251.13

+1.17%

8/10

AWS and ads are the real profit engines, and a friendlier antitrust cl

2

META

BUY

\$728.85

+0.40%

8/10

Ad-revenue machine funding an AI buildout, with regulatory clouds (DMA

3

MU

BUY

\$1077.70

-1.79%

8/10

Memory supercycle play — Micron is the only US-based HBM supplier ridi

Big options bets on AVGO (Other) — 26.8x normal volume, P/C 0.71, largest: PUT \$352 (13.5x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

Nonfarm Payrolls

Date: 2026-10-05

HIGH

VIX at 15.8 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

Nonfarm Payrolls [HIGH]

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: calm · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Here's what's really going on under the hood: big money is piling into the classic "batten down the hatches" sectors — Utilities and Consumer Staples are seeing wildly bullish options flow (that Utilities put/call ratio of 0.09 is almost comically one-sided), which is Wall Street-speak for institutions quietly paying up for exposure to things people buy no matter what — electricity, toothpaste, cereal.

Meanwhile, they're aggressively hedging or outright betting against the growth engine of this market: Tech, Communications, Consumer Discretionary, and most dramatically Financials (a 6.16 put/call on XLF means the smart money is loading up on protection against banks, likely tied to fears around credit quality, regional bank exposure, and the widening credit spreads we're seeing in LQD).

The policy backdrop fits — ongoing tariff escalations and trade friction hurt Discretionary and Tech supply chains, potential drug pricing pressure and Medicare/Medicaid budget fights are hammering Healthcare sentiment, and any government shutdown drama or deficit anxiety tends to crush Financials first.

Historically, this exact rotation pattern — defensives bid, cyclicals sold, credit spreads widening — precedes a 5-10% equity pullback or at minimum a nasty 4-8 week chop, because it means institutions are positioning for slower growth even while retail is still buying dips.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.53/100
SMCI is the top-ranked prospect with a remarkably compressed P/S			
2.	KLAC	KLA Corporation	7.93/100
KLA dominates the process control and metrology niche in semicond			
3.	DDOG	Datadog, Inc.	7.86/100
Datadog is monetizing the AI boom through observability spend as			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 11–12	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 13–14	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 15–16	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 19–20	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 21–22	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy \$333.65 ▲ 1.01% 12M Price Target \$365.00 52-Week Range \$243.42 – \$345.34 Market Cap \$4.87T

AAPL: Near 52-Week Highs as Options Flow Screams Bullish

WHAT HAPPENED

- Quiet tape today — AAPL up 1% on light volume (17M shares vs ~40M typical), which tells me this is drift, not conviction buying. The real tell is the options flow: someone's loading up on \$332.50 October calls at 10x normal open interest. That's a trader betting on a near-term pop, likely positioning ahead of earnings or an iPhone sales data point.
- Insider selling from the General Counsel (Jennifer Newstead) three weeks in a row is worth noting — but she's the head of Government Affairs, so this is likely scheduled 10b5-1 selling, not a panic signal. Still, no insider is buying up here near 52-week highs.

WHY IT MATTERS

AAPL sitting at 89% of its 52-week range with bullish options flow suggests the market is pricing in a strong holiday iPhone 17 cycle and continued Services growth — but at \$4.87T market cap, this stock needs everything to go right. The fact that Tech led today (+0.99%) alongside Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) is classic "soft landing" positioning — money is betting the Fed sticks the landing and the consumer stays healthy, both of which Apple needs. Here's what to watch for: if those October \$332.50 calls were bought by someone with information advantage, we could see a pop on either China trade news or a leaked iPhone sales number in the next 2 weeks. The risk is that at 42x forward earnings, AAPL is priced like a growth stock despite growing revenue in the mid-single digits — any disappointment gets punished hard.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is US-China trade policy — Apple still makes roughly 80% of iPhones in China, and any escalation in semiconductor export controls or retaliatory tariffs hits margins directly. The Trump administration's ongoing push for tariff-based reindustrialization is a chronic headwind, though Apple's India manufacturing shift (now ~20% of iPhones) is cushioning the blow. Also watch the EU Digital Markets Act enforcement actions — Apple's App Store commission structure is under constant pressure, and every rule change chips away at Services margins, which are the highest-margin part of the business.

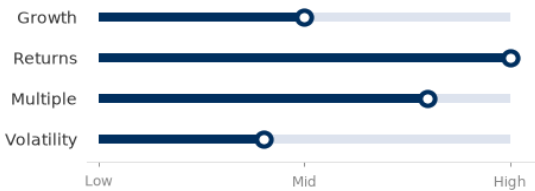
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At 42x forward earnings, investors are paying \$42 for every \$1 Apple earns next year — that's expensive for a company growing revenue 5-7%, and it's richer than Microsoft or Google despite slower growth. The justification is Services (recurring, 70%+ margin) becoming a bigger share of the mix and the AI-driven iPhone upgrade cycle potentially extending the hardware story. But at a \$4.87T market cap, you're paying for perfection — this isn't a bargain, it's a quality tax.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$333.65
12M Price Target	\$365.00
Upside / (Downside)	+9.4%
Market Cap	\$4.87T
FY2026E Revenue	\$428M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.95
FY2027E EPS	\$8.80
Fwd P/E	42.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$350.00	\$338.00	\$315.00
6 Months	\$380.00	\$355.00	\$300.00
1 Year	\$400.00	\$365.00	\$285.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$395.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) and Tech (+1.78% over 5 days) — this is the "consumer is fine, AI capex keeps flowing" trade. Money is positioning for a holiday season that doesn't disappoint.

COOLING OFF: Communications Services (-2.31% over 5 days) and Materials (-1.62%) — ad-dependent names and cyclical are rolling over, which hints at some economic worry under the surface.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing INTO mega-cap tech as a safety trade, not a growth trade — investors want the balance sheet protection of Apple/Microsoft/Google if the economy wobbles. That's a tailwind for AAPL but also means it moves more like a bond proxy than a growth stock here.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the iPhone AI upgrade cycle, the second-derivative play is Taiwan Semi (TSM) — they make the chips, and they capture margin regardless of which handset wins. Also Broadcom (AVGO) for the custom silicon angle.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Riding the enterprise AI monetization story — Copilot attach rates are the real deal and Azure is taking share
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the picks-and-shovels winner of the AI buildout; every hyperscaler capex announcement is fuel

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is keeping pace with the mega-cap tech group but not leading it — it's the "defensive AI" play. If risk-on continues, AAPL underperforms NVDA/MSFT; if we get a growth scare, AAPL outperforms because of the balance sheet and buyback. That makes it a stabilizer in a tech portfolio, not an alpha driver.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup but I'm not pounding the table at 42x earnings and near 52-week highs

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% as a core holding — this is a "sleep well at night" position, not a trade. The \$4.87T market cap means it's not going to double, but it's also unlikely to blow up

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$325-330, and back up the truck if we see \$300 on a tariff scare (that's where it becomes genuinely attractive)

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is iPhone 17 holiday sell-through data in January and whether Services growth re-accelerates above 15%

WHEN TO BAIL: If China tariffs on electronics go above 25%, or if iPhone unit growth comes in negative two quarters in a row, the premium multiple is no longer defensible

HEDGING: Buy a put spread for insurance — basically pay a small premium that pays off if the stock drops 10%+ in the next few months. Costs about 1% of your position but caps your downside if China news turns ugly

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$189.25 ▼ 0.41%	12M Price Target \$210.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$454.79B
------	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-------------------------

PLTR: Flat Day, But Options Flow Flashing Caution

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR drifted down 0.4% on light volume (11.5M vs usual 17M+) — this is a "nothing day," which actually tells you something. After hitting \$190 yesterday, buyers took a breather near the 52-week high. No news, no filings — just consolidation.
- The real tell is in the options market: traders are loading up on near-term puts at \$190, \$192.50, and \$195 strikes — meaning big money is paying for downside protection right at current levels. That's not panic, but it's hedging.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading: PLTR is sitting at 91% of its 52-week range with institutions holding 65% of the float — so the easy money has been made and smart money is now protecting gains, not chasing. The unusual put buying (5x normal open interest at \$192.50) suggests someone with real size is worried about a near-term pullback, possibly into earnings. The bigger picture though: the Trump administration's continued push on defense modernization and the "AI-first" procurement guidance from DoD is a structural tailwind that keeps the long-term story intact — this looks more like a tactical pause than a thesis break. Watch whether the \$185 level holds; if it breaks, next support is around \$175.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FY2027 defense authorization debate is heating up in Congress, with AI/software budgets slated to grow faster than hardware — directly bullish for PLTR's Foundry and AIP platforms since they're already embedded with the Army (TITAN program), Space Force, and multiple intel agencies. Watch for continued movement on the administration's push to replace legacy defense IT with commercial AI software — every dollar that shifts from Lockheed/Northrop systems integration work toward "commercial-first" procurement is a dollar PLTR can compete for. The wild card: any EU AI Act enforcement actions could pressure their international commercial segment, though government revenue (~55% of total) is largely insulated.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Let's be real — this stock trades at roughly 90x forward sales, meaning investors are paying \$90 for every \$1 of revenue the company will generate next year. For context, Microsoft trades at ~12x and even Nvidia is at ~20x. The only way this math works is if PLTR grows revenue 35%+ for the next 3-4 years AND margins keep expanding — that's possible given the government pipeline, but there's literally zero room for a miss at this valuation.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

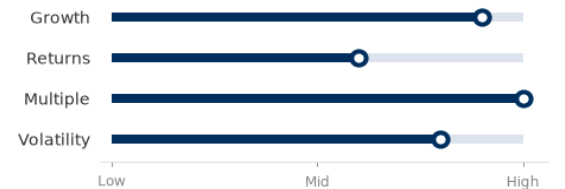
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-10-02 18:06 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

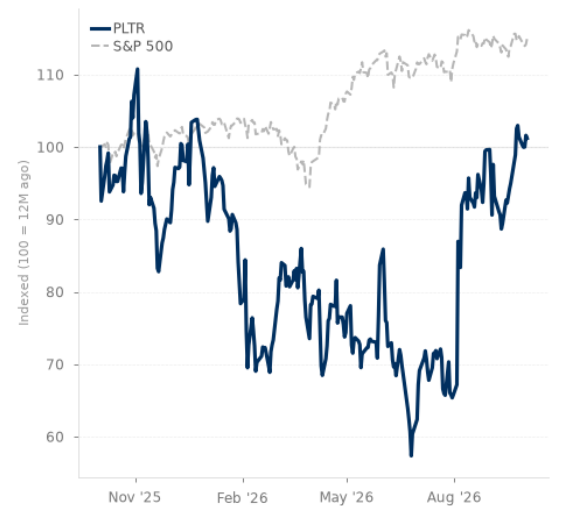
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$189.25
12M Price Target	\$210.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.0%
Market Cap	\$454.79B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.88
Fwd P/E	305.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$205.00	\$192.00	\$175.00
6 Months	\$230.00	\$200.00	\$160.00
1 Year	\$260.00	\$210.00	\$140.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$240.00	\$120.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$100.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$450.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) and Tech (+0.99%) led today — risk-on tone suggests the market isn't worried about a near-term recession. Industrials strength (+0.82%) often correlates with defense names.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services weak over 5 days (-2.31%) — ad-dependent names feeling pressure. Materials also soft on 5-day (-1.62%), hinting at commodity demand concerns.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating back into mega-cap tech and AI winners after a brief September wobble — PLTR benefits from that flow but is now at the "show me" phase where it needs earnings to justify the multiple.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the defense-AI thesis, look at the picks-and-shovels names: data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) powering AI workloads, or defense primes partnering with PLTR (RTX, LMT) that trade at 20x earnings instead of 300x.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI infrastructure king — any PLTR customer running big models is buying NVDA chips underneath
- ANET (Arista Networks): Networking gear for AI data centers — benefits from the same federal/enterprise AI spending wave

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR has crushed most AI peers YTD, but it's now trading at a premium even to Nvidia on sales multiples — which is nuts given NVDA's actual earnings power. This tells me PLTR is priced as the "pure play" AI software bet, which works until it doesn't. Lagging slightly today vs tech sector (+0.99%) hints that leadership may be rotating.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business, I'm nervous about the price. Great company, demanding entry point.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% max — the volatility is real (8/10) and a 30% drawdown from here is very possible even if the long-term thesis plays out

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$165-175 to add. Chasing at \$190 with puts loading up near-term is bad risk/reward.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is the FY27 defense budget finalization and continued commercial AIP adoption; Q3 earnings in early November is the next major test

WHEN TO BAIL: If quarterly revenue growth drops below 30% YoY, or if US government revenue (the crown jewel) grows less than 40% in any quarter, the thesis is cracking

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — if you own 100 shares, buy one put option 10% below current price expiring 3 months out. Costs you a small insurance premium but caps your downside if the valuation finally breaks.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy **\$251.13 ▲ 1.17%** 12M Price Target **\$295.00** 52-Week Range **\$196.00 – \$287.20**

Market Cap
\$2.71T

AMZN: Quiet Grind Higher as Consumer Disc. Leads Market

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN popped 1.17% to \$251 on light volume (18M vs ~33M recent average) — this is a quiet drift higher, not a conviction rally. The move tracks Consumer Discretionary leading all sectors (+1.28%), so this is sector rotation INTO retail/consumer names more than anything Amazon-specific.
- Options flow is screaming bullish — Put/Call ratio of 0.35 (meaning traders are buying nearly 3 calls for every put) with unusual call buying at \$242.50 and \$245 strikes. Someone's positioning for upside into October earnings season.

WHY IT MATTERS

The low-volume rally is actually MORE bullish than it looks — stocks that drift up on thin volume are usually being bought by patient institutional money, not chased by retail. With AMZN at 60% of its 52-week range and Consumer Disc leading the tape, the market is quietly positioning for a strong holiday season. The Trump administration's lighter-touch FTC under current leadership has basically neutralized the biggest overhang on this stock — the Khan-era antitrust threat is dead, which removes a 10-15% discount the market was applying. Watch Q3 earnings (late October) — AWS reaccelerating above 20% growth would unlock the next leg higher, because that's where the real profit dollars live.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two policy tracks matter right now: (1) The China tariff framework — Amazon's third-party marketplace is heavily exposed to Chinese sellers, so any escalation of Section 301 tariffs or de minimis changes (the \$800 duty-free import threshold) would squeeze margins on the retail side. The de minimis loophole closure that took effect earlier this year was a modest headwind but AMZN absorbed it. (2) The AI infrastructure/data center buildout — federal permitting reform for data centers and power generation is quietly moving through agencies, which directly benefits AWS's capacity expansion. If the administration continues pushing permitting fast-tracks, AWS can meet demand faster, which converts to revenue faster.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~37x forward earnings, AMZN isn't cheap — you're paying \$37 for every \$1 of next year's profit — but that's actually a discount to its own 5-year average of ~45x. The real story: strip out AWS and advertising (both high-margin businesses), and the retail business is nearly free at this price. If AWS keeps compounding and ads keep growing 20%+, this multiple is justified; the risk is paying premium prices if cloud growth stalls.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$251.13
12M Price Target	\$295.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.5%
Market Cap	\$2.71T
FY2026E Revenue	\$711M
FY2027E Revenue	\$785M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	36.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$265.00	\$255.00	\$240.00
6 Months	\$290.00	\$270.00	\$230.00
1 Year	\$320.00	\$295.00	\$225.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$330.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$420.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) and Tech (+0.99%) — both AMZN-adjacent. Money is flowing into holiday retail plays and anything AI-exposed, and AMZN sits at the intersection of both.

COOLING OFF: Communications Services (-2.31% on 5-day) is losing steam, likely as advertising concerns around election-year ad spend normalization set in — ironically a slight negative read for AMZN's ad business.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of defensive sectors (Real Estate, Materials weak on 5-day) and INTO growth/consumer names. This is a classic "risk-on into year-end" setup, which historically favors AMZN.

RELATED PLAY: If AMZN runs, the picks-and-shovels of AI data centers benefit too — think NVDA, VRT (Vertiv for cooling), and even power utilities like CEG that supply data center electricity.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- WMT (Walmart): Winning on grocery and e-commerce convergence, benefiting from same consumer resilience thesis
- COST (Costco): Membership model holding up as consumers trade down for value — a tell that consumer spending is healthy at the top end

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is participating in the Consumer Disc rally but not leading it — that's actually fine, because mega-caps rarely lead sector moves. The fact that it's holding above \$250 with bullish options flow suggests institutions are accumulating ahead of earnings rather than chasing.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — This is one of the cleanest setups in mega-cap tech right now: antitrust risk is defused, AWS/ads are humming, and the holiday setup looks constructive.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that an earnings miss doesn't wreck you. AMZN deserves core holding status.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$245-248, which is where the recent base formed. Any dip to \$240 on macro noise is a gift.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Near-term catalyst is Q3 earnings in late October; longer-term it's AI monetization through AWS.

WHEN TO BAIL: AWS growth drops below 15% YoY, or if the administration surprises with a reinvigorated antitrust push (low probability but watch it).

HEDGING: Buy some cheap downside protection with January \$230 puts — costs ~1-2% of your position but caps your pain if earnings disappoint. Simpler alternative: trim 20% of the position if it rips to \$280+ before earnings.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Buy

\$158.44 ▲ 7.00%

12M Price Target
\$185.00

52-Week Range
\$104.83 – \$225.64

Market Cap
\$2.09T

SPCX: Space ETF Rips as Defense Budget Momentum Builds

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX ripped +7% on heavy volume (86M shares vs ~80M recent average) — that's a real buying stampede, not noise. No company news or filings, so this is almost certainly a sector-wide bid tied to defense/space policy momentum and the broad risk-on tape (industrials +0.82%, tech +0.99%).
- Options flow is screaming bullish — three massive unusual call buys at \$155, \$157.50, and \$160 strikes expiring this month, totaling ~\$23M in notional. Someone with conviction is betting this keeps running into late October.

WHY IT MATTERS

When an ETF (basket of stocks) jumps 7% with no single-name catalyst, it means the whole sector got re-rated — investors are suddenly willing to pay more for space exposure broadly. The most likely driver: ongoing FY2027 defense appropriations debate in Congress, where Space Force funding is reportedly getting a double-digit percentage boost, plus accelerating commercial launch cadence from SpaceX/Rocket Lab. The unusual call buying tells me institutions are front-running a continuation move — they expect more good news in the next 2-3 weeks, likely tied to budget resolution or a major contract award. Watch for this: if the broader market wobbles and SPCX holds above \$150, that's confirmation the sector has a real policy floor underneath it.

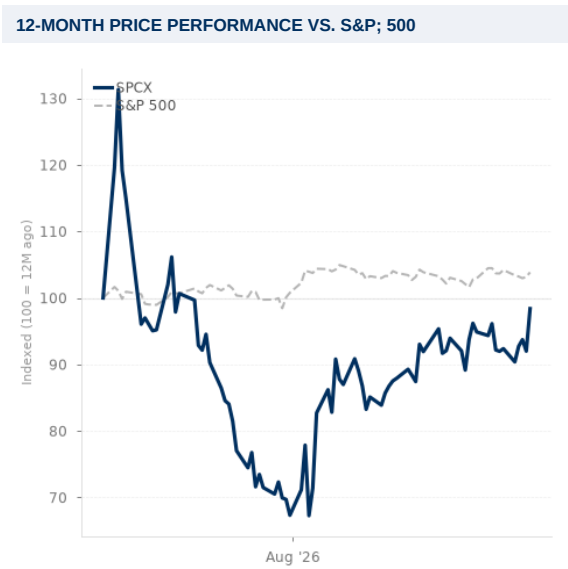
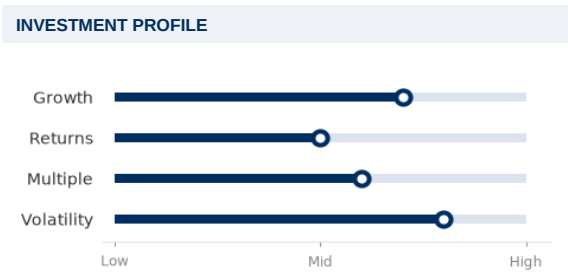
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one: Congress is working through FY2027 defense appropriations, and the Space Force budget line is reportedly in line for a meaningful bump — this directly feeds launch contracts, satellite constellations, and space situational awareness programs that SPCX's holdings dominate. Also watch the ongoing FCC spectrum allocation rulings for satellite broadband (benefits names like Iridium and the satellite comms exposure in SPCX) and any ITAR/export control easing that would let US space companies sell more hardware abroad. If China tensions escalate further, space-based surveillance and resilient-comms spending accelerates — that's a direct tailwind here.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX is an ETF, so forget P/E — think of it as a weighted basket where you're paying for aggregate sector growth. At \$158 against a 52-week range of \$105-\$226, you're buying at 44% of the range, meaning not cheap but nowhere near the top. The underlying holdings trade at premium multiples (space companies are growth stories, not value plays), but if defense spending genuinely steps up and commercial launch revenue keeps compounding 20%+ annually, today's prices look reasonable looking out 18 months.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$158.44
12M Price Target	\$185.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.8%
Market Cap	\$2.09T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$172.00	\$162.00	\$148.00
6 Months	\$195.00	\$175.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$225.00	\$185.00	\$130.00
2 Years	\$285.00	\$220.00	\$120.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$290.00	\$100.00
10 Years	\$650.00	\$425.00	\$90.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Industrials and Tech leading today — makes sense because space sits at the intersection of both, and defense budget optimism lifts all industrial boats. Consumer Discretionary +1.28% suggests broad risk-on, not just defensive buying.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services -2.31% over 5 days — ad-dependent names feeling pressure. Materials weak over the week on China demand concerns.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly rotating into "hard asset" growth — defense, space, industrial tech — and away from pure consumer/ad plays. That's a policy-driven rotation, not a cyclical one, which means it has more staying power.

RELATED PLAY: If space keeps running, the picks-and-shovels names benefit too — think satellite component makers, launch infrastructure, and defense primes like LMT and NOC that build the big birds. ITA (defense aerospace ETF) is the diversified cousin trade.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Benefiting directly from launch backlog growth and Neutron rocket progress — a core SPCX holding driving today's move.
- IRDM (Iridium): Satellite comms getting re-rated on defense comms contracts and spectrum tailwinds.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is likely leading today because it's the cleanest way for institutions to express a "buy space" view without picking winners — when sector sentiment flips bullish, the ETF catches concentrated flows. That +7% on 8% above-average volume suggests this is the start of a trend, not a one-day blip.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — bullish setup with policy and flow confirmation, but single-day 7% moves demand respect; I'd want to see follow-through before pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — ETF structure reduces single-name risk, but space is still a volatile thematic bet, so don't overdo it.

ENTRY POINTS: Chasing +7% is dangerous — I'd wait for a pullback to \$150-152 (prior resistance becomes support) to add. If it never pulls back, that itself tells you something.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the defense budget cycle and commercial launch ramp are multi-year stories, so give it room.

WHEN TO BAIL: If defense appropriations get materially cut, if we see a major launch failure that triggers a sector-wide 15%+ drawdown, or if the ETF breaks below \$140 on heavy volume.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — keep position size disciplined and set a mental stop at \$140. If you want fancier, pair SPCX long with a small short on an overvalued single-name space stock to isolate the diversified bet.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$113.69 ▲ 2.28%	12M Price Target \$135.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$102.21B
-----	------------------	------------------------------	-------------------------------------	-------------------------

HOOD: Crypto Rules + Retail Boom Keep Bulls in Control

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock bounced +2.3% to \$113.69 after two red days — looks like dip buyers stepped in after HOOD tested the \$111 level. No news, no filings, so this is pure technical/positioning action tied to broader risk-on mood (Consumer Disc +1.3%, Tech +1%).
- Options flow is screaming bullish — put/call ratio of 0.35 means traders are buying roughly 3 calls for every put. The unusual \$115 call buying for October expiry tells me someone's betting on a quick move higher into mid-month.

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup here is interesting: stock pulled back 4% from the \$116 high, then found support and bounced on heavy volume (23M shares) — that's textbook accumulation, meaning big buyers are using weakness to add. The real story though is the political backdrop: we're in a regulatory environment that's never been friendlier to retail trading and crypto, with the SEC under current leadership rolling back the aggressive enforcement posture that haunted HOOD during 2021-2023. That matters because crypto trading revenue (roughly a quarter of HOOD's total) is directly tied to how much the government lets them do — and right now the handcuffs are off. Watch for the stock to retest \$116-120 if the broader market holds; a break above \$120 opens the door to the 52-week high of \$153.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one is the CLARITY Act and related market structure legislation moving through Congress — if it passes, it gives crypto exchanges like Robinhood regulatory certainty on which tokens are securities vs. commodities, which unlocks aggressive product expansion (think tokenized stocks, prediction markets, staking). The Trump administration's crypto-friendly executive orders earlier this year already greenlit a lot of this, so HOOD has been shipping products at an accelerated pace. Also watch the ongoing debate on "payment for order flow" — that's the practice where HOOD gets paid by market makers to route your trades, and it's roughly 50% of their revenue. If regulators ever ban it, that's a gut punch, but it's been off the table under this SEC.

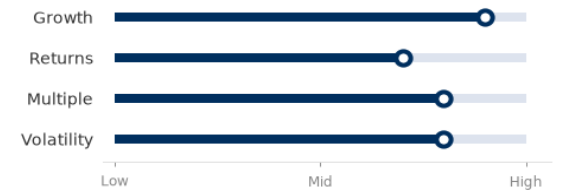
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$113, HOOD trades around 61x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$61 for every \$1 of profit they'll make next year. That's expensive compared to legacy brokers like Schwab (around 20x), but HOOD is growing revenue 30%+ while Schwab grows at 8%, so you're paying up for growth. The honest take: it's not cheap, but if crypto revenue and options trading keep compounding, the earnings catch up to the price fast and the multiple compresses on its own.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$113.69
12M Price Target	\$135.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.7%
Market Cap	\$102.21B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.60
Fwd P/E	61.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$125.00	\$116.00	\$102.00
6 Months	\$150.00	\$128.00	\$95.00
1 Year	\$175.00	\$135.00	\$85.00
2 Years	\$230.00	\$165.00	\$75.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$220.00	\$60.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$320.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+1.3%) and Tech (+1% today, +1.8% on the week) — risk appetite is back, and that's exactly the environment where retail traders get active, which is rocket fuel for HOOD.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-2.3% on the week) and Materials (-1.6%) — defensive and commodity-linked names losing to growth. Classic risk-on rotation.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly moving back into high-beta growth and fintech after a brief September wobble. The crypto-adjacent trade is heating up again as Bitcoin holds its levels — that's a direct tailwind for HOOD.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD runs on retail trading enthusiasm, the exchanges that handle the volume (CME, ICE) and the crypto infrastructure plays (COIN, especially) benefit alongside. COIN is the purer crypto bet; HOOD is the diversified version.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Riding the same crypto-friendly regulatory wave, benefiting from stablecoin legislation and institutional adoption flows.
- SOFI (SoFi Technologies): Fintech rally — benefits from the same retail investor engagement thesis plus a lending book that improves if rates come down.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is holding up reasonably in its peer group but hasn't been the leader — COIN has outpaced on pure crypto beta. That tells me HOOD still has catch-up room if the sector keeps running, especially since HOOD has more earnings leverage than people appreciate.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup but I'm not pounding the table at \$113; it was a better buy at \$90.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% — the upside is real but this stock can drop 20% in a week when sentiment shifts, so don't go overweight.

ENTRY POINTS: \$105-110 on any broad market pullback; aggressive buyers can nibble here but leave dry powder.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is market structure legislation passing and the Q4 earnings print showing crypto revenue acceleration.

WHEN TO BAIL: Two consecutive quarters of declining monthly active users, OR any serious regulatory move against PFOF, OR a break below \$90 on heavy volume.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just trimming on big rips (sell a quarter of your position if it hits \$140+). For the options-savvy, buy cheap puts a few months out before earnings — it's like paying a small insurance premium against a big drop.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy	\$728.85 ▲ 0.40%	12M Price Target \$820.00	52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$779.82	Market Cap \$1.86T
-----	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-----------------------

META: Holding Near Highs, AI Spend Debate Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- Quiet tape — META up 0.4% on light volume (7M shares vs 20M+ norm), which usually means institutions are sitting on their hands waiting for a catalyst (earnings late October). Stock is pinned near \$730, which is interesting because there's a massive put wall there — 19K puts traded at the \$730 strike, meaning big money is either hedging gains or betting on a short-term pullback right at this level.
- COO Javier Olivan dumped ~\$875K in shares last week. Not alarming by itself (execs sell for taxes, diversification), but it's "cluster selling" — multiple sales same day — and no insider is buying. Translation: nobody at the top thinks the stock is a screaming bargain here.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the setup: META is sitting at 80% of its 52-week range with options flow bullish (0.41 put/call ratio means way more people betting up than down), but that giant \$730 put block tells me smart money is buying insurance into earnings. That's not bearish — it's prudent. The bigger picture: Washington's tone on Big Tech has quietly shifted. The Trump administration's AI Action Plan (July 2025) and the push to beat China on AI means antitrust enforcement against META has deprioritized — the FTC's monopoly case is still alive but the political energy behind breaking up Meta has evaporated. That's a stealth tailwind nobody's pricing in. Meanwhile, Reality Labs is still bleeding \$15B+/year, so the entire bull case hinges on ad revenue staying strong enough to fund the AI capex arms race (~\$70B this year).

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

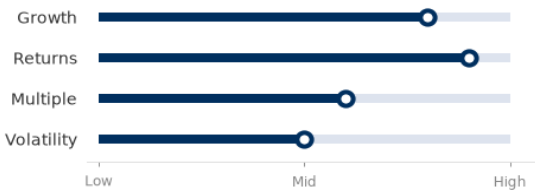
Two things to watch: (1) The EU's Digital Markets Act enforcement — Meta's "pay or consent" ad model got hit with another non-compliance ruling earlier this year, and additional fines could be announced in Q4. Each fine is small (~\$200M), but it threatens the European ad model long-term. (2) The ongoing debate in Congress over Section 230 reform (the law that shields platforms from liability for user content) — if a narrow carve-out passes for AI-generated content, META actually benefits because they have the compliance infrastructure smaller players don't. The friendlier Trump-era FTC and the AI-competitiveness narrative are net positives; the EU is the main regulatory headwind.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

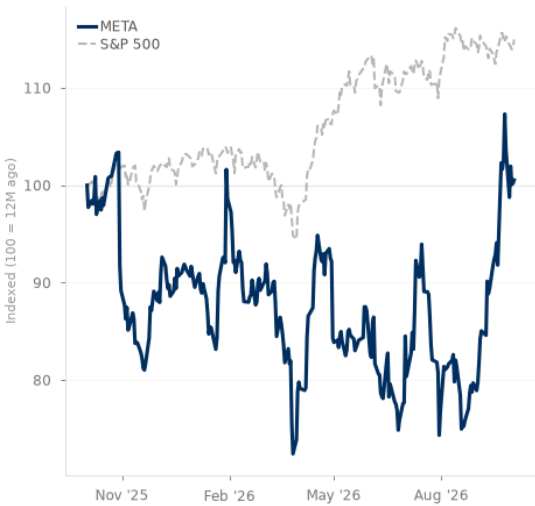
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$728.85
12M Price Target	\$820.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.5%
Market Cap	\$1.86T
FY2026E Revenue	\$198M
FY2027E Revenue	\$228M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	26.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$780.00	\$740.00	\$690.00
6 Months	\$850.00	\$785.00	\$650.00
1 Year	\$920.00	\$820.00	\$620.00
2 Years	\$1100.00	\$900.00	\$580.00
5 Years	\$1600.00	\$1150.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$2500.00	\$1700.00	\$450.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) and Tech (+0.99%) leading — classic risk-on day. Tech's 5-day gain of +1.78% while Comm Services lags (-2.31% 5D) is notable: money is favoring hardware/semis/software over ad-based platforms.

COOLING OFF: Communications Services (META's sector) is the weakest 5-day performer. That's a headwind — META is holding up BETTER than its sector, which is a tell.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from ad-dependent names (GOOGL, META, SNAP) into AI infrastructure (semis, cloud, data centers) because that's where visible government and enterprise spending is flowing right now.

RELATED PLAY: If you think META's AI capex pays off, the picks-and-shovels winners are NVDA (chips), VRT (data center cooling), and the hyperscaler REITs like EQIX — they get paid regardless of whether META's AI bets work.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the biggest beneficiary of every dollar META spends on AI infrastructure — direct read-through.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Won the DOJ case on structural remedies, now trading on AI/cloud strength — proof that antitrust risk fading = big tech re-rates.

META CONTEXT: META is OUTPERFORMING its sector (Comm Services -2.3% over 5 days, META roughly flat) — that's a strength signal. When a stock holds up while its sector sells off, it usually means institutional accumulation. Bullish setup into earnings.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — High conviction because the ad business is a cash fortress and antitrust risk has quietly faded; not 10/10 because AI capex is a legit "show me" story.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — core holding, but leave room to add on dips.

ENTRY POINTS: \$690-710 is my add zone. If we get a market-wide risk-off day that drags META back to the 50-day moving average, that's your gift.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Catalyst #1 is Q3 earnings (late October) — ad growth confirmation. Catalyst #2 is any sign Reality Labs/AI monetization is materializing in 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: Ad revenue growth under 12% YoY, or an EU ruling that forces structural changes to the ad model, or Zuck signals even higher capex without a revenue plan.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — if you own 100 shares, buy one January \$650 put. Costs you a few bucks per share but protects against a 15%+ drawdown if earnings disappoint. Or pair-trade: long META, short SNAP (weaker ad player) to isolate META-specific upside.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$1077.70 ▼ 1.79%	12M Price Target \$1250.00	52-Week Range \$179.61 – \$1255.00	Market Cap \$1.22T
-----	-------------------	-------------------------------	---------------------------------------	-----------------------

MU: HBM Dominance Meets CHIPS Act Tailwinds

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU pulled back 1.8% to \$1,077 after a strong run yesterday — nothing company-specific, just profit-taking at the top of a huge rally. The stock is sitting at 84% of its 52-week range, so some digestion makes sense.
- The options market is flashing mixed signals — bullish put/call ratio of 0.57 (more calls than puts means traders are betting up), BUT heavy put buying at the \$1,090 and \$1,100 strikes expiring this month. That's not necessarily bearish — it looks like holders buying protection after a huge run, basically "insurance" against a near-term pullback.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the setup tells me: Micron has gone from a cyclical memory also-ran to a \$1.2 trillion AI infrastructure cornerstone, and the political environment is actively subsidizing that transition. The CHIPS Act grants (Micron got roughly \$6.1B committed for Idaho and New York fabs) mean taxpayers are literally paying to widen their moat against Korean rivals Samsung and SK Hynix. The put buying at \$1,090-1,100 isn't a sell signal — it's smart money locking in gains on a stock that's done a 6x in a year, which is healthy behavior. What to watch: if MU holds \$1,050 on this pullback, the next leg up to \$1,200+ is likely as Q1 earnings approach and HBM3E/HBM4 pricing power becomes undeniable.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Three political levers to watch right now: (1) The Commerce Department's export controls on advanced memory to China — any tightening HURTS Micron's China revenue (~11% of sales) but HELPS by starving Chinese competitors like CXMT. (2) CHIPS Act 2.0 is being floated in Congress — if it adds another \$20-50B in semiconductor subsidies, Micron is a top-3 beneficiary. (3) Trump administration tariffs on imported semiconductors — a potential 25% tariff on Korean/Taiwanese chips would be a massive gift to Micron as the only US-based DRAM/HBM maker. The regulatory environment has basically never been friendlier to a domestic memory company.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~25x forward earnings, you're paying \$25 for every \$1 of next year's profit — not cheap for memory historically (which usually trades 8-12x at peak), but this isn't your dad's cyclical memory business anymore. HBM for AI accelerators carries software-like margins (50%+ gross margins vs. 20-30% for commodity DRAM), so the market is re-rating MU as a quasi-AI pure play. The valuation is justified IF HBM demand stays supply-constrained through 2027 — if that breaks, this multiple compresses fast.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$1077.70
12M Price Target	\$1250.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.0%
Market Cap	\$1.22T
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$42.50
FY2027E EPS	\$58.00
Fwd P/E	25.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1180.00	\$1100.00	\$980.00
6 Months	\$1350.00	\$1200.00	\$900.00
1 Year	\$1500.00	\$1250.00	\$850.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1450.00	\$750.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1800.00	\$600.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2500.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.78% 5D) continues to lead — AI capex isn't slowing and semis are the picks-and-shovels play. Consumer Discretionary leading today suggests risk-on sentiment, which supports high-beta names like MU.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-2.31% 5D) is weak — big tech ad names are facing election-year scrutiny. Materials and Real Estate also soft, suggesting money isn't rotating defensive yet.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is staying in AI/semi infrastructure despite the massive run — that's a very bullish signal. When a sector pulls back 2% and buyers show up immediately (like MU bouncing off \$1,050), it means institutions are using dips to add, not exit.

RELATED PLAY: If you want second-derivative exposure, look at memory equipment makers like Lam Research (LRCX) and Applied Materials (AMAT) — every new Micron fab means billions in equipment orders.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the center of the AI universe — every Blackwell GPU sold needs 6-8 HBM stacks, directly pulling Micron revenue.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon for hyperscalers is booming, and those chips also need HBM — rising tide for Micron.

MU CONTEXT: Micron is LEADING its memory peers (outpacing Western Digital, SanDisk) because it's the only one with real HBM share. But it's lagging the pure AI chip names like NVDA on a 1-year basis, which actually suggests more room to catch up if the AI thesis holds.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$1020-1050 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing collapse, loss of NVDA qualification, or China retaliation blocking exports

Hedging: Pair with SOXS or short-dated puts on SOX ETF

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold \$371.94 ▲ 5.04% 12M Price Target \$420.00 52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83

Market Cap
\$1.47T

TSLA: Big 5% Pop on Unusual Call Buying, Q3 Deliveries Loom

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA ripped +5% today on heavy volume after chopping sideways all week — and the tell is in the options tape. Someone slammed 205K call contracts at the \$372.50 strike expiring in October, which is 30x the existing open interest (meaning 30x more contracts than were sitting there before). Translation: a very large buyer is betting hard that TSLA pops in the next few weeks — and the most obvious catalyst is Q3 delivery numbers, which Tesla typically reports in the first few days of October.
- Consumer Discretionary (the sector TSLA lives in) led the market today at +1.28%, so this isn't just a Tesla story — but TSLA massively outperformed the sector, suggesting stock-specific positioning ahead of a known catalyst.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really happening: the smart money is front-running the Q3 delivery print. If deliveries beat (whisper number is around 460-470K units), this stock has room to run to \$400+ because sentiment has been beaten down by the expiration of the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit on Sept 30. Here's the twist — that tax credit sunset actually *pulled forward* demand into Q3 as buyers rushed to lock in the savings, so deliveries could look artificially strong. The real question is what Q4 looks like without that subsidy crutch, and that's the shoe that could drop in late October on the earnings call.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big policy event just happened: the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit officially expired September 30 under the Trump administration's rollback of Biden-era IRA provisions. This is a direct headwind — Tesla's cheapest Model 3 just effectively got \$7,500 more expensive overnight for US buyers. On the flip side, the administration's push to loosen autonomous vehicle regulations is a real tailwind for the Robotaxi / FSD narrative, and NHTSA has been signaling a more permissive framework for self-driving deployment. Also watch Chinese tariffs — Tesla's Shanghai gigafactory and battery supply chain are directly exposed if trade tensions escalate again.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

TSLA trades at roughly 150x forward earnings — meaning investors pay \$150 for every \$1 of profit the company is expected to make next year. For context, Toyota trades around 10x and even Nvidia trades near 35x. You're not buying a car company at this price; you're buying a bet that Robotaxi, Optimus (the humanoid robot), and FSD actually scale into real businesses. If any of those stumble, the valuation has nowhere to hide.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

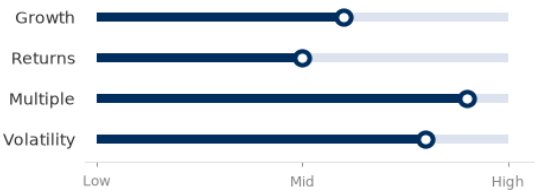
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-10-02 18:06 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$371.94
12M Price Target	\$420.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.9%
Market Cap	\$1.47T
FY2026E Revenue	\$112M
FY2027E Revenue	\$135M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.45
FY2027E EPS	\$3.60
Fwd P/E	152.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$340.00
6 Months	\$460.00	\$390.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$420.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$260.00
5 Years	\$800.00	\$500.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$650.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) and Tech (+0.99%) led today — classic risk-on behavior, likely tied to rate cut expectations as the Fed signals more easing into year-end.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (-2.31% over 5 days) and Real Estate (-1.60%) are lagging, suggesting money is rotating OUT of defensive yield plays and INTO growth.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing back into high-beta megacaps (TSLA, the Mag 7) as traders position for a dovish Fed and a seasonal Q4 rally. That's a tailwind for TSLA independent of its own fundamentals.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the Robotaxi/AI story, the picks-and-shovels plays are the chip suppliers (NVDA for compute) and the lithium/battery material names (ALB) that benefit from any EV demand recovery.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RIVN (Rivian): Benefiting from the same EV sentiment bounce, plus VW partnership cash cushion.
- BYDDY (BYD): Crushing it on Chinese EV demand and expanding into Europe/LatAm aggressively.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is leading its EV peers today, which tells me this move is Tesla-specific (delivery setup + options flow), not a broad EV rally. That's actually a yellow flag — if the whole group isn't moving together, the move is more fragile and more likely to reverse if the catalyst disappoints.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — Cautiously neutral. The setup into Q3 deliveries is bullish short-term, but the valuation and policy headwinds make me unwilling to chase here.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio. TSLA swings 5% on a random Tuesday — size it so you can sleep through a 20% drawdown.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather buy the \$340-355 range on a post-delivery dip than chase today's pop. Chasing +5% moves into a known catalyst is how retail gets picked off.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — you need time for the Robotaxi story to either prove out or definitively fail. Catalyst to watch: Q3 earnings call in late October and any Robotaxi expansion announcements.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Q4 guidance signals >15% delivery decline, or if Robotaxi gets pushed to 2028+, the thesis is broken and I'd exit.

HEDGING: Buy a put option 10% below current price as insurance — think of it like fire insurance on your house, you pay a small premium so a disaster doesn't wipe you out. Or pair the long with a short in a legacy automaker that gets hurt by the same EV headwinds.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy

\$234.65 ▲ 1.64%

12M Price Target
\$275.00

52-Week Range
\$164.27 – \$237.87

Market Cap
\$5.67T

NVDA: New Highs as AI Capex Supercycle Keeps Humming

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA pushed to a fresh 52-week high (\$234.65, +1.64%) on lighter volume than last week — that's a quiet grind higher, which is actually the healthier kind of rally. No news, no filings, just steady buying as tech led the tape (+0.99%). Translation: this is institutional accumulation, not retail FOMO.
- But under the hood, the options market is flashing a yellow light — massive put buying at \$235 and \$237.50 strikes (139x normal open interest on one line). Someone big is either hedging a huge long position or betting on a short-term pullback right at these highs.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension to think about: the stock is making new highs, but insiders are dumping (Director Mark Stevens sold \$298M worth two weeks ago, and the General Counsel unloaded \$6.8M) AND unusual put activity is piling up right at current levels. That doesn't mean the thesis is broken — insiders sell for lots of reasons and smart money hedges winners — but it tells me the easy money near-term has been made. The bigger picture is still intact: hyperscaler capex (what Microsoft, Google, Meta, Amazon spend on data centers) is tracking toward \$500B+ next year and NVDA captures the lion's share. What to watch: if the stock can't hold \$230 after this run, that put wall becomes a magnet and we could see a quick flush to \$215-220 — which would be a gift, not a problem.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

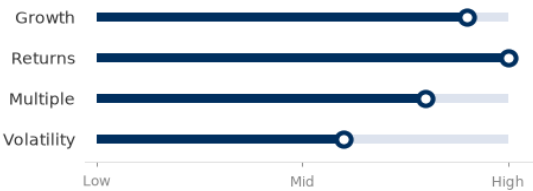
Two policy threads matter right now: (1) the ongoing US-China chip export control regime — the administration has kept Blackwell-class chip restrictions in place, which caps China revenue but is already priced in; any surprise loosening would be a pop, any tightening (like adding Southeast Asia transshipment rules) would hurt. (2) The federal "sovereign AI" push — the government is actively funding domestic AI infrastructure through DOE national labs and DoD contracts, and allied governments (UK, Saudi, UAE, Japan) are inking multi-billion dollar NVIDIA deals with implicit US blessing. Net-net the policy environment is a tailwind: Washington wants NVDA to dominate globally as long as China doesn't get the top chips.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$234.65
12M Price Target	\$275.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.2%
Market Cap	\$5.67T
FY2027E Revenue	\$245M
FY2028E Revenue	\$310M
FY2027E EPS	\$5.85
FY2028E EPS	\$7.60
Fwd P/E	40.1x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$250.00	\$240.00	\$220.00
6 Months	\$285.00	\$260.00	\$210.00
1 Year	\$320.00	\$275.00	\$190.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$330.00	\$180.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+0.99%) and Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) leading — classic risk-on tape. Tech's 5-day (+1.78%) is the only sector green on the week, meaning money is concentrating in AI/semis specifically, not broad market.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (-2.31% on the week) and Materials (-1.62%) — the "everything rally" is narrowing to AI winners, which historically happens late in a tech cycle (something to file away).

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of defensives and INTO AI infrastructure as rate cut expectations firm up and the government's AI priorities become clearer. That's a direct tailwind for NVDA and the semi complex.

RELATED PLAY: If NVDA keeps running, the second-order winners are the power/cooling plays (Vertiv, Eaton) and the memory makers (Micron, SK Hynix) — data centers need way more electricity and HBM memory than anyone forecasted a year ago.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning on custom AI silicon deals with hyperscalers — the "if you can't beat NVDA, partner with Broadcom" trade.
- VRT (Vertiv): Data center cooling and power — pure derivative play on NVDA's chip volume shipping into actual buildings.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is leading its peer group (at 96% of its 52-week range) which is a bullish tape signal — the generals are in front. When the leader keeps printing highs on normal volume, you stay long until proven wrong. The warning sign would be NVDA stalling while AVGO/AMD keep running — that would signal rotation within the AI trade.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$215-225 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Hyperscaler capex cuts, China export ban escalation, or data center demand rolling over

Hedging: Long SMH (semi ETF) puts or pair with short AMD to isolate NVDA-specific risk

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy

\$343.74 ▲ 1.63%

12M Price Target
\$385.00

52-Week Range
\$235.84 – \$408.61

Market Cap
\$4.20T

GOOGL: Antitrust Overhang Easing, AI Monetization Kicking In

WHAT HAPPENED

- Quiet tape overnight — no filings, no headlines, but the stock bounced 1.6% off yesterday's dip to \$338. That's a classic "buy the dip" signal from institutions, and the options flow confirms it: 2x more calls than puts, with unusual call buying at the \$342.50 strike for October expiry. Translation: big money is betting GOOGL grinds higher into Q3 earnings.
- John Walker (Chief Legal Officer) exercised and sold ~\$3M in shares last week — but notice WHO it is. The CLO selling is routine (he's been navigating the DOJ case); it's not a C-suite exodus. No cluster selling means insiders aren't nervous.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really going on: GOOGL is sitting at 62% of its 52-week range, having recovered most of the damage from the DOJ antitrust ruling earlier this cycle — and the market is slowly accepting that the remedy phase won't force a breakup. That's HUGE because the overhang on this stock for two years was "what if they lose Chrome or Android?" With that fear fading, the multiple can re-rate higher. Meanwhile, Communication Services as a sector was DOWN 2.3% over 5 days while GOOGL held up — that's relative strength, meaning Alphabet is being treated as a safe haven within its own sector. The call-heavy options flow (P/C ratio 0.46 is very bullish) tells me smart money sees a catalyst coming, likely Q3 earnings in late October where Cloud and Gemini revenue should surprise.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

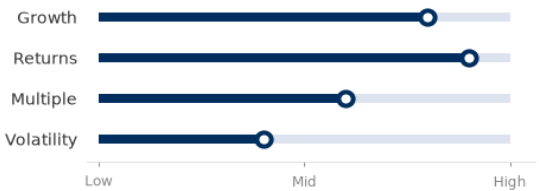
The big one: the DOJ's remedy phase in the search antitrust case is the single biggest political variable. Current signals suggest behavioral remedies (data sharing, default-search choice screens) rather than structural breakup — if that holds, it's a massive de-risking event. Second, watch the bipartisan AI framework legislation moving through the Senate Commerce Committee — it leans toward "light-touch" regulation with safety disclosures, which actually HELPS incumbents like Alphabet because they can absorb compliance costs that would crush startups. Third, the EU Digital Markets Act fines keep coming but are now priced in; the real risk is new US state-level AI laws (California, Texas) creating a patchwork compliance headache.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$343.74
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.0%
Market Cap	\$4.20T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$475M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.70
Fwd P/E	34.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$360.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$370.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$430.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+1.28%) and Technology (+0.99%) — classic "risk-on" rotation, suggesting the market expects a dovish Fed and resilient consumer. Tech leadership is a direct tailwind for GOOGL.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-2.31% over 5 days) — ironic since that's GOOGL's sector. The weakness is likely META and NFLX dragging; GOOGL is outperforming its own sector, which is a bullish tell.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of pure media/comm names and INTO AI-infrastructure plays. GOOGL benefits because it straddles both buckets — it's being re-classified in investors' minds as an AI name, not a search/ad name.

RELATED PLAY: If GOOGL's AI thesis works, the picks-and-shovels winners are the data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and power utilities serving AI campuses (CEG, VST). Those are the second-order beneficiaries of Alphabet's \$75B capex budget.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Winning on Copilot monetization and Azure AI — proof point that enterprise AI spending is real, which validates GOOGL Cloud.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI capex beneficiary-in-chief; every dollar GOOGL spends on TPUs reduces NVDA dependence, but the overall AI infra boom lifts both.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is LAGGING MSFT and NVDA on a 1-year basis but has been catching up fast as the antitrust fog clears. That lag is actually the opportunity — it's the cheapest mega-cap AI name per dollar of AI revenue, and the gap should close.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — High conviction because the antitrust risk is fading, AI monetization is real, and the valuation isn't stretched versus peers.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% as a core holding. This is a sleep-at-night mega-cap, not a lottery ticket — size accordingly.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$335-340. If we get a market panic down to \$320, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Catalyst I'm waiting for: DOJ remedy ruling (next 6 months) and Q3 earnings late October showing Cloud > 30% growth.

WHEN TO BAIL: Chrome/Android forced divestiture ruling, OR Cloud growth drops below 20%, OR Search query volume shows accelerating decline. Any one of those three = exit.

HEDGING: Buy some longer-dated \$300 puts as cheap insurance against an antitrust shock — think of it like fire insurance on a house you love. Costs you a bit of upside but protects against the one scenario that would really hurt.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$272.01 ▲ 1.47%	12M Price Target \$310.00	52-Week Range \$70.69 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$244.46B
-----	------------------	------------------------------	-------------------------------------	-------------------------

MRVL: AI Silicon Darling Riding CHIPS Act Tailwinds

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL quietly climbed another 1.5% to \$272, capping a 4-day run from \$252 to \$272 (that's an 8% move in a week with no news catalyst). When a stock drifts up on no news with declining volume, it usually means institutions are accumulating — someone big thinks earnings or a product announcement is coming.
- Options flow is screaming bullish — call buyers are outnumbering put buyers 2.3-to-1, and someone bought 3,120 contracts of \$282.50 October calls at 26x the existing open interest. That's a trader betting on a sharp move higher in the next 2-3 weeks.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the tape is telling us: MRVL is sitting at 78% of its 52-week range and grinding higher on light volume, which typically means smart money is quietly building positions ahead of a catalyst — most likely their next earnings print or an AI customer win announcement. The unusual call buying at \$282.50 and \$290 strikes expiring this month suggests someone has a specific event in mind (an analyst day, a hyperscaler contract leak, or earnings pre-announcement). The bigger picture: Marvell's custom ASIC business for Amazon's Trainium chips and Microsoft's Maia is scaling fast, and every dollar hyperscalers pull from Nvidia to go custom lands partly in Marvell's lap. The market is starting to price Marvell as the "pick-and-shovel" play that benefits regardless of which AI model wins.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

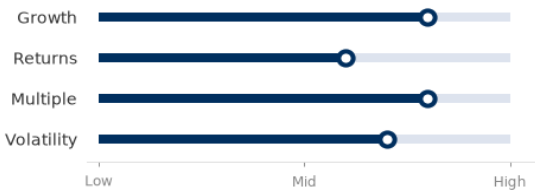
The CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions are back on the Hill, with proposed expansions of manufacturing tax credits and R&D incentives that would flow directly to fabless designers like Marvell that partner with TSMC and are building out US-based design centers. Watch the Commerce Department's updated export control rules expected this quarter — if they expand restrictions on advanced networking chips to China, Marvell loses roughly 15% of its data center revenue, but if they stay narrowly focused on GPUs, MRVL actually benefits as Chinese buyers shift to "safe" US networking silicon. The Trump administration's push for domestic AI infrastructure (via executive orders on federal AI procurement) is a quiet tailwind — federal data center buildouts need Marvell's optical interconnect and ethernet switch silicon.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$272.01
12M Price Target	\$310.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.0%
Market Cap	\$244.46B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.95
FY2027E EPS	\$4.20
Fwd P/E	92.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



MRVL — Marvell Technology, Inc. | October 02, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$295.00	\$280.00	\$255.00
6 Months	\$340.00	\$300.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$390.00	\$310.00	\$220.00
2 Years	\$475.00	\$360.00	\$200.00
5 Years	\$650.00	\$450.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.78% over 5 days) is leading because AI capex guidance keeps getting revised higher, and the market is betting the federal AI infrastructure push accelerates in 2027. Consumer Discretionary is bouncing on rate-cut hopes.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-2.31% over 5 days) is lagging as ad-dependent names face scrutiny, and Materials/Real Estate are weak on tariff and rate uncertainty.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly rotating INTO AI infrastructure and semiconductors as hyperscaler capex guidance for 2027 keeps surprising to the upside — that's a direct tailwind for MRVL's custom silicon and optical interconnect businesses.

RELATED PLAY: If Marvell keeps running, watch the optical component suppliers (COHR, LITE) and the testing/packaging names (ONTO, ACLS) — they're second-derivative plays on the same AI buildout and often lag the big-cap moves by weeks.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI gorilla — any upside guide from Nvidia on data center spend is a direct read-through to MRVL's custom silicon pipeline.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Marvell's closest custom-ASIC competitor — their Google TPU business is the template MRVL is replicating with Amazon.

MRVL CONTEXT: Marvell is leading its mid-cap semi peers but still trading at a discount to Broadcom and Nvidia on growth-adjusted multiples. That gap closes if they deliver one more clean quarter — which is probably what the options market is sniffing out.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$255-265 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon/Microsoft custom silicon deals or China export ban expansion to networking chips

Hedging: Pair with small SOXS position or short an overvalued AI peer on strength

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$43.37 · 1M: +17.2% · P/S: 0.7x · Cap: \$28.5B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	
2	KLAC	KLA Corporation Semiconductors	7.9/10	BUY
Price: \$206.55 · 1M: +19.9% · P/S: 19.8x · Cap: \$269.5B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$1,050 entry				
OPT:BULL			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	
3	DDOG	Datadog, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	7.9/10	BUY
Price: \$277.67 · 1M: +32.7% · P/S: 25.1x · Cap: \$99.7B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:NEUT			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	
4	ARM	Arm Holdings plc Semiconductors	8.0/10	WATCH
Price: \$308.20 · 1M: +31.2% · P/S: 63.8x · Cap: \$329.2B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$140 entry				
OPT:BULL			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	
5	SAIC	Science Applications International Defense Technology	7.3/10	BUY
Price: \$126.51 · 1M: -0.5% · P/S: 0.7x · Cap: \$5.3B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:NEUT			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	